Using the NM Assistant app:

There are two basic uses of this app, the more common usage being the first:

1. **BASIC USAGE** Save for later use one or more offline maps.
   1) Save a map showing a track you wish to hike
   2) Save a map showing only a region (no track) where you will hike

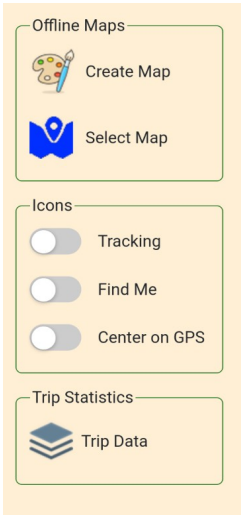
   In either case, you can pull up the map for display later - with or without internet – and a pulsing blue dot will show your location.
2. **CREATING HIKE TRACKS** while you hike. It can be shared, emailed or saved when you end the hike.

1. BASIC USAGE: Offline Maps

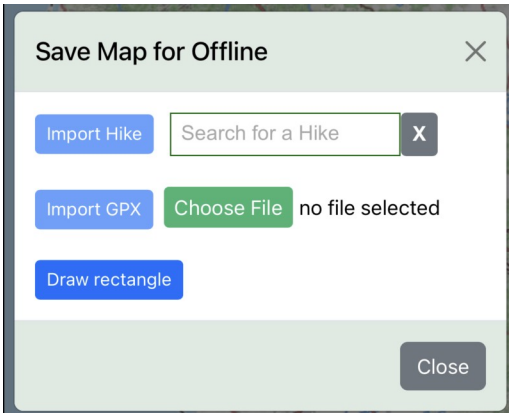
When you first open the app, it will show a large area map centered on Albuquerque. When you 'Allow Location Services" the map will re-center on your current US location *wherever you are*. This location is saved, so that if you go to a place where there is no internet and you open the app, it will default to display this (last opened) location.

The Menu:
To use offline maps, you must first save one. Click on the 'Menu' icon to open the menu. 

You will see the following menu [The menu can be closed by tapping anywhere outside the menu]



The first thing to do is to tap "Create Map".
You will see the following:

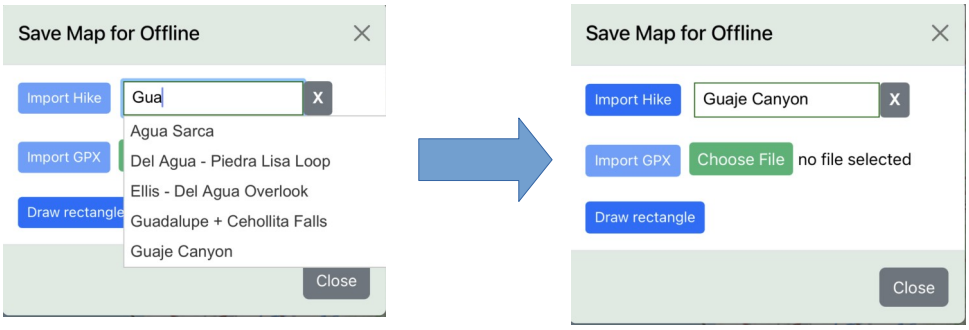


This shows that there are three ways to save maps:

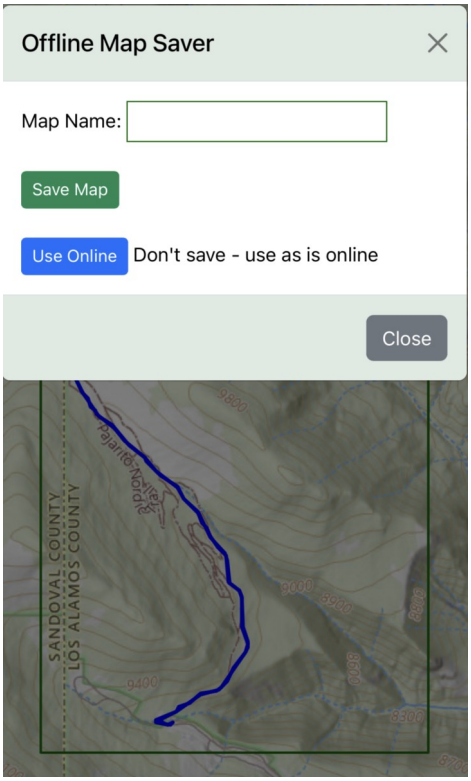
1. Import a hike directly from nmhikes.com (a primary feature of this app!)
2. Import any .gpx file (from your phone's file folder, iCloud, Google Drive, or other app)
3. Pan the map to an area you wish to save for later, and draw a rectangle to capture it (discussed below)

The three methods are detailed below:

1. Import nmhikes.com hike: simply begin typing the name of the nmhikes.com hike into the search box, then click on the hike of interest. It will then display in the search box, and the "Import Hike" button will now be enabled (darker blue).

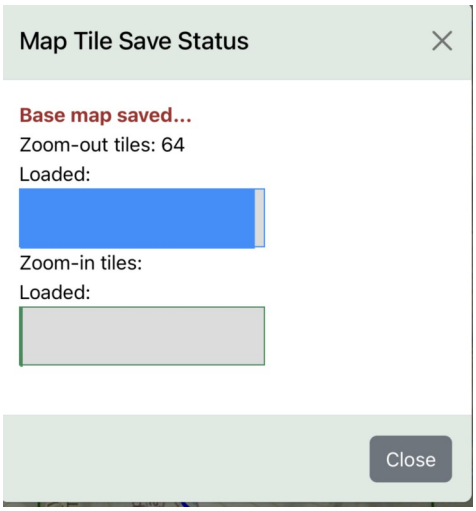


Click the ‘Import Hike’ button to display and save the map:



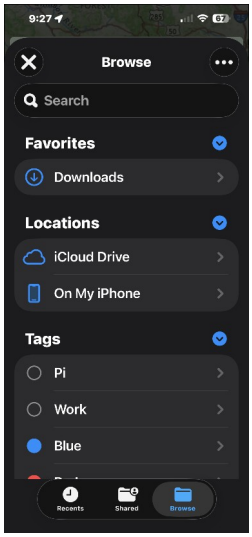
Enter a name for the map;
Then tap ‘Save Map’. If you don’t want to save it and just want to use it while connected to the internet, tap ‘Use Online’

If you are saving the map, you will see a Save Status window showing the progress of saving:



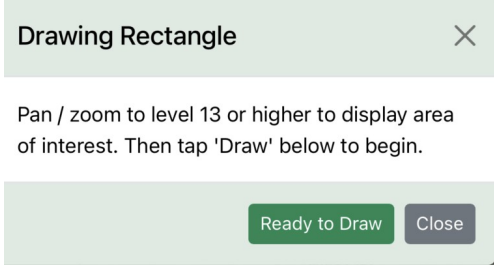
When the Save Status window shows “**SAVED!**”, you can close the window – the map has been saved.

2. GPX File: the process is virtually the same as above, except you are going to import an existing “.gpx” file from your phone. When you tap the green “Choose File” button, your phone will browse available locations. The display differs between android and iPhone. iPhone example:

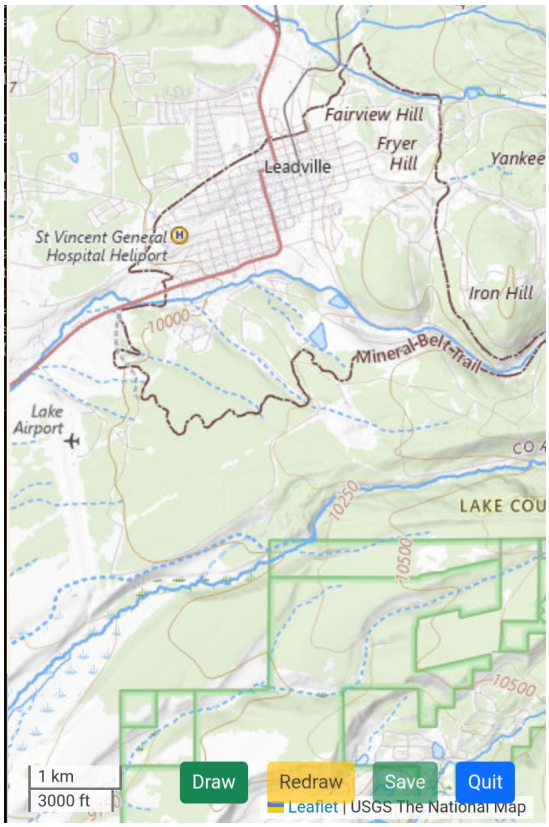


After selecting a file, simply tap the now-enabled (darker blue) “Import GPX” button, and the remaining process of saving is the same as previously described.

3. Draw Rectangle: Use this when you are going somewhere and there is no gpx file or nmhikes.com hike to import. When you tap the ‘Draw Rectangle’, you will see the following:



At this point, simply tap ‘Ready to Draw’, then pan anywere and zoom to the area you want to save. Note that the zoom level is always shown on the map in the upper left corner. In order to save the area, **you must zoom in to zoom level 13 or higher** – lower zoom levels consume too much memory. Here is an example of panning and zooming near *Leadville, CO*.

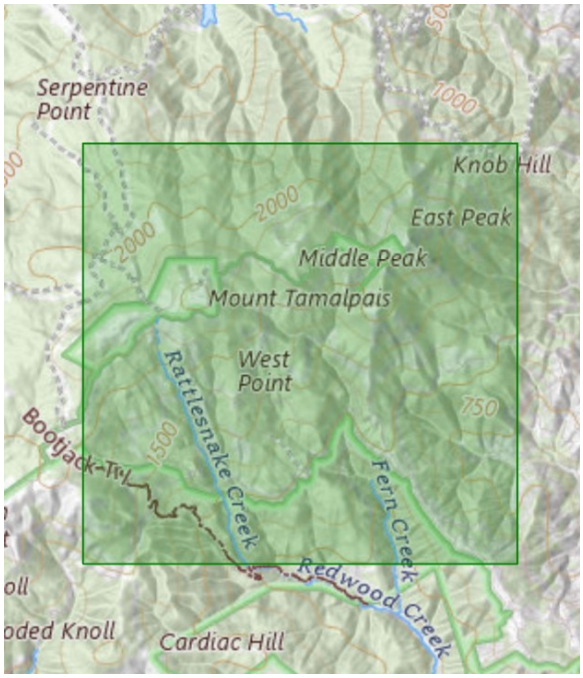


Note the buttons: Tap ‘*Draw*’ when you are ready to draw a rectangle on the map with your finger. When you are done, tap ‘*Save*’. If you don’t like the area you chose, you can tap ‘*Redraw*’ and then ‘*Draw*’ again, to get a new area. Tap ‘*Quit*’ to exit at anytime without saving. See the drawn example [“Area to be saved”] below…

Saving is the same process as described previously. The ‘*Save*’ button is not enabled until the drawing is completed

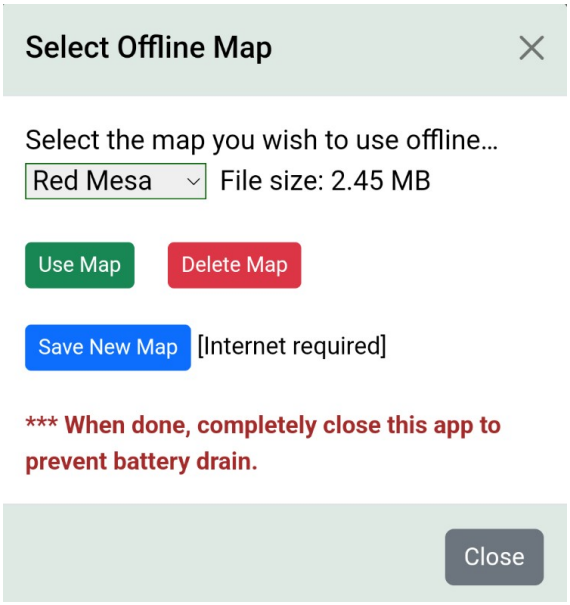
NEXT you will want to use your offline map when you arrive at your destination. Internet is no longer needed! Whether internet is available or not, the process is the same, described on the next page.

The area-to-save is drawn by placing your finger on one corner of the rectangle enclosing the desired area, then dragging it to the opposite corner and lifting your finger from the screen. Start from any corner...



Area to be saved

Use a saved offline map:
Open the menu and tap the ‘Select Map’ icon. The following dialog box will appear:



After selecting the map you wish to use from the drop-down box, you can:

1. Use the map displayed in the selection drop-down,
2. Delete the map from memory, or
3. If you have internet, you can go back to Save New Map.

When you tap Use Map, the map and any track saved with it will be displayed - again internet not required. A pulsing blue dot will indicate your location as you move around.

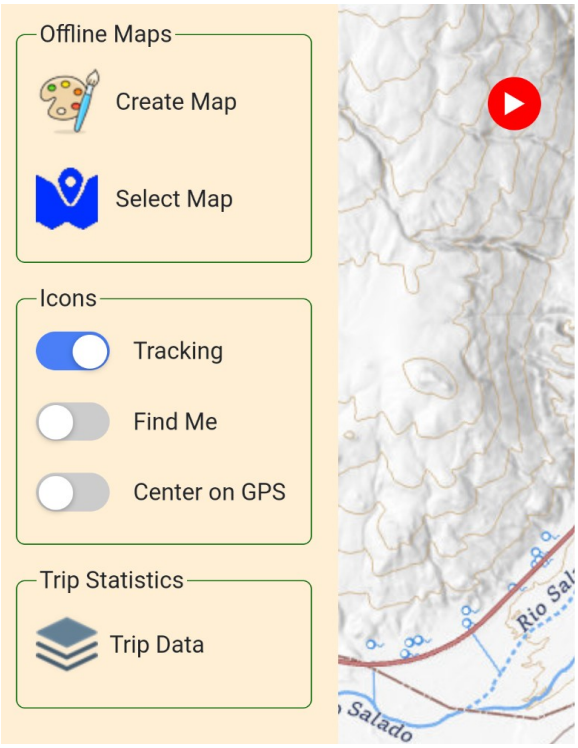


After tapping ‘Use Map’ [User not in the area – no dot]

2. CREATING HIKE TRACKS: Online or Offline

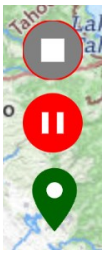
The process for creating a track – a record of your hike – is the same whether internet is available or not (online or offline). The tracking mechanism will follow you as you move and draw a red line of the path you have taken. Note that the saved track (if present) will be in blue, so you can always tell if you are following the saved route.

Tracking must first be enabled by tapping the menu, and then tapping the Tracking icon slider. The slider will move to the right and turn blue, and the tracking icon (red circle with right-facing arrow) will appear on the map to the right of the menu:



→ Start Tracking

When you are ready to record your hike, tap the tracking icon (red circle). When you do this you will see other items appear, and the tracking icon will be replaced by a 'stop tracking' icon:

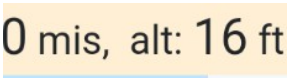


→ Stop tracking

→ Pause tracking

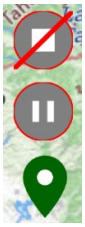
→ Add a marker

Near the bottom of the map, you can always see a real-time display of distance traveled and current elevation



Your path will be recorded now, whether or not the phone's display is on, or whether you minimize the app and bring up another app, or answer a phone call, etc. This is one of the primary benefits not always offered by other apps. You should be aware of the difference between 'minimizing' the app and 'closing' the app. For example, on an iPhone, swiping up from the bottom minimizes the display, but the app is still running. To completely close an app, you must swipe up from the bottom again, which will display all minimized apps. Swipe up on a displayed app to close it completely. Verify it is closed by swiping up again to make sure the app no longer appears. For android users, check your process.

If you wish to pause tracking for any reason – e.g. a lunch stop, etc – simply tap the Pause Tracking button. This will cause the pause button to change to a new icon, and the StopTracking button will now have a line drawn through it to show that you are not currently tracking.

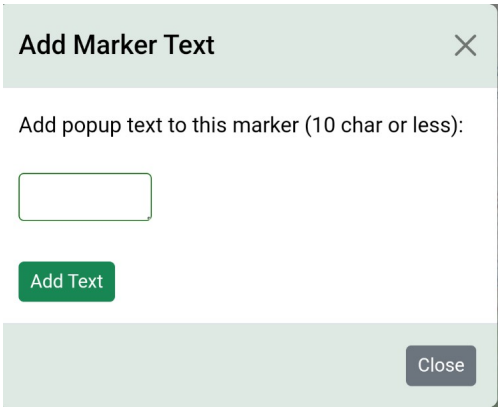


→ No longer tracking

→ Tap to turn pause off

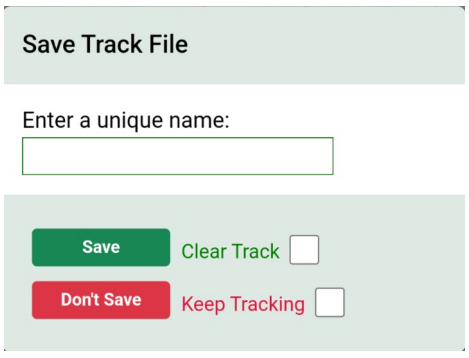
Tapping the pause icon again (now gray) will restore the tracking mode and the pause button. Note that later you can view the time you have hiked altogether, and also the 'moving' time: time the track was not paused. (See Trip Data, below)

The third option is the green marker icon. When you tap this, a marker is placed on the map at your current location – handy if you want to mark an important feature, like a fork in the trail or point of interest. When the icon is placed, a dialog box will appear on the screen asking you to enter any text you would like to use to identify the location – valuable when you have more than one marker. The text will appear as a 'pop-up' next to the maker when the marker is tapped. Tap again to hide the pop-up text.

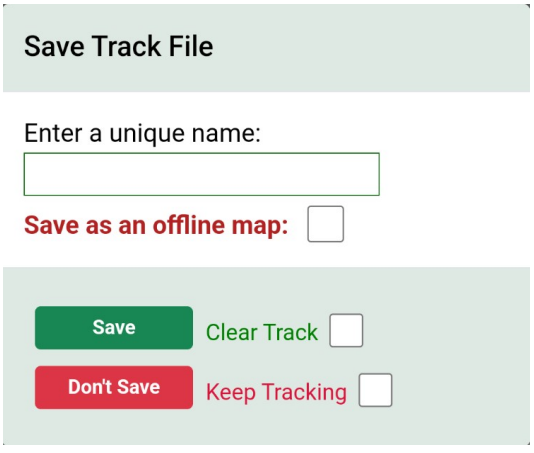


When you are ready to stop tracking, simply tap the 'Stop Tracking' icon. What will happen next is that a dialog will appear allowing you to save the track you have created – or not. If you tap 'Save' without tapping the 'Clear Track' box, the created track will be saved and it will continue to display on the map. If you tap the 'Clear Track' box and then 'Save', the current track will be saved, but the map will no longer display your track. Similarly, tapping 'Don't Save' without clicking 'Keep Tracking' will discard the data and clear the track. 'Keep Tracking' retains the data and continues to track. NOTE: When offline only, an additional option allows you to save the file and save a map version as well.

When Online:



When Offline:

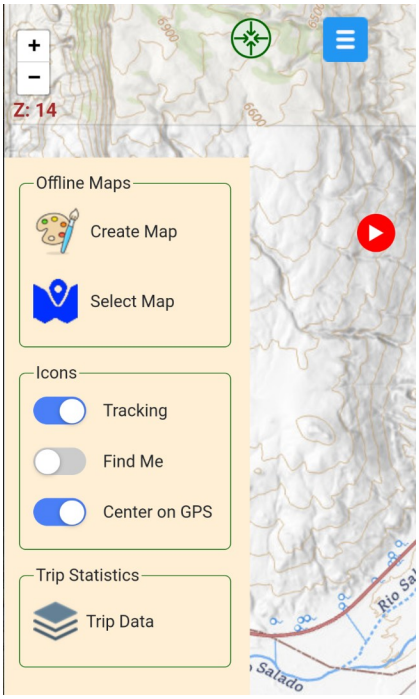


Note that when saving a track, your menu choices will depend on your phone's operating system. For android phones, the track file is always saved to the Documents folder. For iPhones, you can email, share, or save the file to different locations. In either case, when saved, you now have a gpx file that can be shared with others, or displayed on any of the various GPX viewers (see attachment below), or even be used to create a new map using the app's Import GPX

Saved GPX File displayed in online viewer:



Two other icons related to tracking can be useful. Tap the menu and then tap the Center on GPS slider. This will move the slider to the right and turn the slider blue. It will also place a green 'centering' icon at the top of the screen.





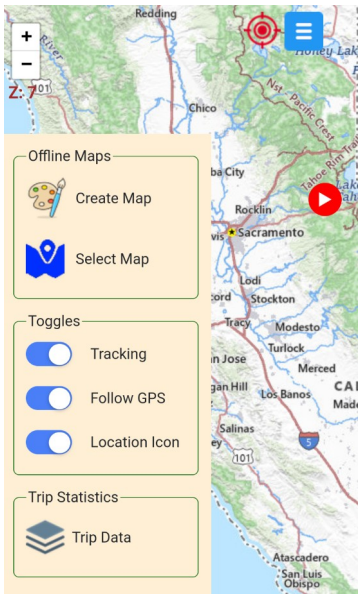
→ Tap to make map always center on the location dot



→ Tap to allow the map to be panned anywhere

The default state allows you to pan the map anywhere while using the tracking feature. When you pan the map won't snap back and center on the GPS dot. If you wish to always have the map display your location in the center, use the centering icon. Return to the default state by tapping the centering icon with the red line through it. You can now pan anywhere.

The other slider, the Find Me icon, displays a red 'target' icon near the menu. This icon, when tapped, simply centers the map once on your current location. This can be handy if, for some reason, you are displaying a portion of the map that doesn't show your current location (the blue pulsing dot).

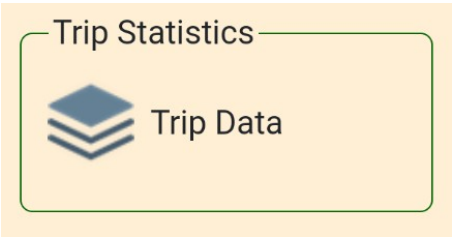


Red 'target' location icon →

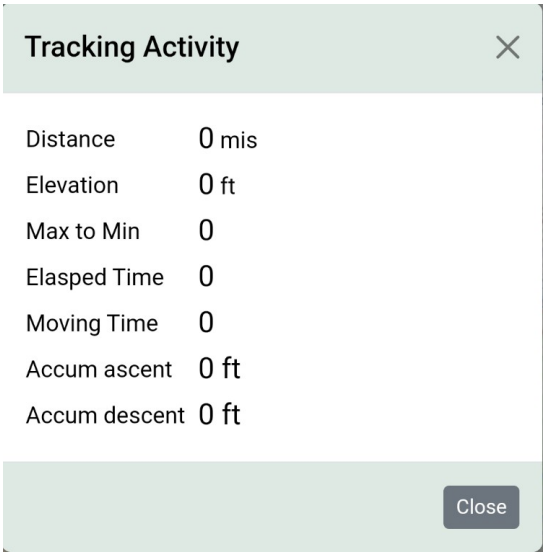


Geolocation will 'find you' and center the map on your current location.

The final menu item is labeled Trip Data. At any point during the hike, or after the track is saved, you get a summary of hike stats by simply tapping the icon.



The data will display for any current or previous track saved until a new track is initiated – at which point all stats return to zero:

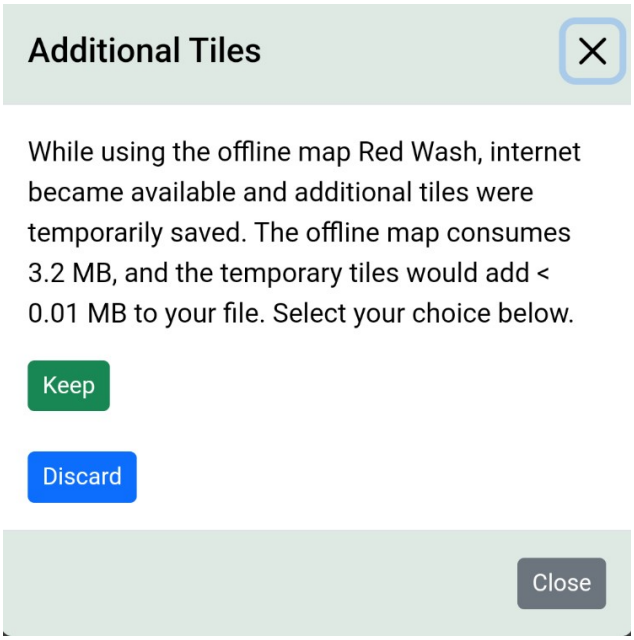


Advanced Feature:

There is one more feature of this app added to expand your saved offline map coverage, depending on internet availability. If you Select Map to display a saved offline map, and internet happens to be available at the time, this feature is activated. What happens is that the map coverage can be expanded to include whatever can be seen while internet is on. For example, if you have an offline map displayed, and pan over to another location, the additional map area displayed by the pan action is stored temporarily. None of the additional storage is combined with your current map automatically – you can always choose to add it or not. The only time this opportunity arises is when the feature is active and:

- You select a new offline map before closing the app
- You close the app then re-open it later

You will see a dialog box asking if you wish to add the coverage to your saved offline map so that it will be included the next time you select that map for display. The amount of memory consumed by the saved map is displayed; also the amount of memory the additional coverage consumes is provided so you can make an informed decision. You can add it to the saved map, or decline. This is generally handy if you are extending your hike outside the boundary of the saved map (and internet is available). In that case your offline map can include the new map territory. Maps are broken into small square pieces called ‘tiles’, so the extended coverage is said to represent ‘additional tiles’.



The dialog states which map is affected, and what happened. It also tells you how much memory the offline map consumes, and how much memory would be added if the additional tiles are kept. If you simply close the window, it may appear again when you select a map or re-open the map, so it is best to either ‘keep’ or ‘discard’ the tiles.

That concludes the app tutorial. Enjoy using this new app!

Note: you can report any anomalies to: *admin@nmhikes.com*